

Ten Tools You Will Need

Here are 10 tools you need to keep handy when you're going to do an upgrade job on your computer.

1. A complete screwdriver set with a tester

This is, of course, the most essential thing of all. Remember that trying to use a single screwdriver in a one-size-fits-all style may seem to work for many screws, but you'll be wearing down the screw heads—and this is entirely avoidable by getting a complete set.

2. A multimeter

This can help check for grounding problems, checking whether the power supply is working fine, finding out which IDE power supply cables aren't working, and so on.

3. Pliers, tweezers, wire cutters, and other such tools

These are available at any hardware store, and are the same as those required for any other kind of mechanical work. Tweezers, for example, are a great help when screws fall into the computer case and you want to get them back out.

4. A set of screws

This is essential. You may get screws supplied with your motherboard if you're doing a motherboard upgrade and so on, but unless you're doing a major upgrade like this, you'll need to purchase a set of screws at your local hardware store. Get as many sizes and shapes as you can.

5. A hard disk mounting rack

This is useful if you have only a 5.25-inch bay left and you need to put in a regular 3.5-inch drive.

6. IDE cables

These are available at any computer store. You may want long ones or short ones, depending on how you've placed your drives and the placement of the connectors on your motherboard. In